The Well-Tempered clAIvier

Fugue XXII in B-flat minor, twenty-three voices: Tombeau "Ma fin est mon commencement" (crab fugue)

Four choirs (5 + 6 + 6 + 6 voices), open score, twenty-three keyboards

Claude / Sam (subject after J. S. Bach, BWV 867, ending B-A-C-H)

I. Intonatio

Grave, alla breve -- the second half is the first played backwards (♩ = 88)

Coro I Soprano

Coro I Alto — *Subject (after BWV 867, ending B-A-C-H)*

Coro I Tenore — *Answer*

Answer (soprano)

II. Consolatio

Subject (baritone), stretto at the half bar

Coro I Baritono

Coro I Basso — *Subject (bass)*

Coro II Soprano

Coro II Mezzosoprano — *Answer in A-flat (Coro II)*

Coro II Alto

Coro II Tenore — *Subject in D-flat major, stretto at the half bar*

Coro II Baritono

Coro II Basso — *Answer in A-flat (bass)*

Coro III Soprano

Coro III Mezzosoprano

Coro III Alto

Coro III Tenore

Coro III Baritono

Coro III Basso

Coro IV Soprano

Coro IV Mezzosoprano

Coro IV Alto

Coro IV Tenore

Coro IV Baritono

Coro IV Contrabbasso

24

III. Speculum

IV. Crux

S1

A1

T1

Bar1

B1 — *Subject in D-flat major (soprano), stretto at the half bar*

S2

Ms2 — *Answer in B-flat minor (Coro II alto)*

A2

T2 — *Subject in E-flat minor (Coro II baritone), stretto at the half bar*

Bar2

B2

S3 — *Inversion (soprano), ending on the summit*

Ms3 — *Inversion in E-flat minor (Coro III)*

A3

T3 — *Subject, with its augmentation (canon per augmentationem)*

Bar3 — *Subject (baritone)*

B3 — *Subject in E-flat minor (bass), stretto at the half bar*

Subject in augmentation (B-A-C-H on the axis)

S4

Ms4

A4

T4 — *Subject (ending on the axis)*

Bar4

B4

48

Axis: IV. Crux cancrizans

III. Speculum cancrizans

II. Consolatio cancrizans

S1 A1 T1 Bar1 B1 S2 Ms2 A2 T2 Bar2 B2 S3 Ms3 A3 T3 Bar3 B3 S4 Ms4 A4 T4 Bar4 B4

Answer in B-flat minor (Coro II alto) (cancrizans)

Subject in E-flat minor (Coro II baritone), stretto at the half bar (cancrizans)

Inversion (soprano), ending on the summit (cancrizans)

Inversion in E-flat minor (Coro III) (cancrizans)

Subject, with its augmentation (canon per augmentationem) (cancrizans)

Subject (baritone) (cancrizans)

Subject in E-flat minor (bass), stretto at the half bar (cancrizans)

Subject (ending on the axis) (cancrizans)

70

I. Intonatio cancrizans

Answer (soprano) (cancrizans)

Subject (after BWV 867, ending B-A-C-H) (cancrizans)

Answer (cancrizans)

Subject (baritone), stretto at the half bar (cancrizans)

Subject (bass) (cancrizans)

Subject in D-flat major (soprano), stretto at the half bar (cancrizans)

Answer in A-flat (Coro II) (cancrizans)

Subject in D-flat major, stretto at the half bar (cancrizans)

Answer in A-flat (bass) (cancrizans)